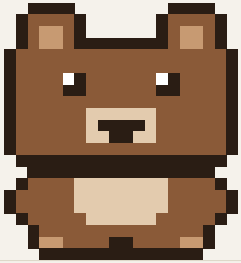
ROMA TRE · A.Y. 2026/27

Policy Evaluation Lab

Lab 3: A case study, university scholarships



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So, today we are going to evaluate a case study

1. We look at a real case study
2. Form groups of **2–3 people** at most
3. Study what the question is asking, and look at the data
4. Formulate some opinions, and the approach you would use
5. Present your results

Today's lab: a case study

Our country has a rather low share of people with a university degree and considerable inequality in access to tertiary education. Those who come from a family in economic difficulty, and whose parents have a low level of education, are less likely to enrol at university.

To encourage people to undertake university studies, the Italian State has introduced several measures. The main one is a **scholarship** for people who enrol in a degree course. To obtain it, there are both **merit** requirements and requirements linked to the **income** of the student's family. The management of the measures for the right to university study (*diritto allo studio universitario*, DSU), meaning financial contributions and services for students, is delegated to the **Regions**. Recently this measure has been considerably strengthened.

Table 1: scholarships by region

Region	Scholarships awarded	Eligible students	Regular enrolled	% of holders away from home	Total spending (€ thousand)
Liguria	3,264	3,264	25,108	43.8	8,205
Lombardia	25,861	25,933	243,972	44.4	78,952
Piemonte	15,843	15,843	95,440	46	48,219
Valle d'Aosta	131	131	814	35.9	293
Emilia-Romagna	22,607	22,607	142,182	39.1	76,124
Friuli-Venezia Giulia	5,286	5,286	24,248	37	18,612
Trentino-Alto Adige	2,902	2,902	14,510	50	8,309
Veneto	14,698	15,661	95,442	37	44,121
Lazio	21,959	21,959	246,730	66.6	73,636
Marche	5,227	5,227	35,318	81	21,613
Toscana	11,887	11,887	83,711	67.5	49,270
Umbria	4,506	4,506	23,227	55.2	15,446
Abruzzo	4,694	5,322	32,151	48.2	14,215
Basilicata	1,021	1,021	3,796	15.4	2,079
Calabria	10,282	10,798	27,714	66.9	36,226
Campania	27,543	27,543	120,803	6.6	111,646
Molise	902	1,081	5,214	16.5	3,116
Puglia	18,100	18,100	61,775	17.1	49,589
Sardegna	9,074	9,074	27,168	46.1	31,779
Sicilia	18,804	21,134	81,052	20.3	43,057
Italy	**224,591**	**229,279**	**1,390,375**	**40**	**734,507**

Students of degree courses in Italian universities, academic year 2021/2022; spending in calendar year 2021. "Regular enrolled": students enrolled within the normal duration of their course (*iscritti regolari*). "Away from home": *fuori sede*. Source: MEF written exam, 31 March 2025 (envelope 2, not drawn). The data were constructed for the exercise and do not necessarily correspond to real values.

The questions

Based on the information provided in Table 1, analyse the main evidence describing the process of awarding scholarships across the regions, indicating also which indicators it would be useful to compute, and how.

In addition, illustrate which strategy could be adopted, and which other data would be needed, to evaluate the effectiveness of the scholarships for the right to university study in terms of improving the academic performance of enrolled students.